AI FUTURE MAKERS

STUDENT CHALLENGE GUIDE

Choose ONE Challenge. Build ONE AI Solution.

CHOOSE 1 OF 5 CHALLENGES

Your team must select ONE challenge option below. After choosing, continue to the matching challenge section for the full problem, examples, build direction and expected output.

01	**OPTION 1 - SCREEN** **Beyond the CV: AI-Assisted Candidate Screening**	Help HR review and screen large numbers of job applications faster.
02	**OPTION 2 - MATCH** **Better Talent Matching**	Help HR identify which candidate is the best fit for which role.
03	**OPTION 3 - HIRE** **Fairer & Faster Hiring**	Help HR improve one part of the hiring process.
04	**OPTION 4 - RETAIN** **Early Employee Disengagement**	Help HR understand employee difficulties earlier.
05	**OPTION 5 - GROW** **Purpose, Potential & Career Growth**	Help HR develop employees and identify internal growth opportunities.

YOUR FIRST STEP: Choose ONE challenge only.

Then continue to the matching challenge section to understand the problem and start building.

How to Start

Use the same simple method for any challenge.

1. Choose ONE challenge area.
2. Choose ONE HR or employer pain point.
3. Choose ONE user: HR, recruiter, hiring manager, supervisor or employee.
4. Describe what happens today and where time, quality or clarity is lost.
5. Build the smallest useful solution and show exactly where AI adds value.
6. Keep important decisions reviewable by people.
7. Test whether your prototype improves the current process.

START WITH THIS SENTENCE We are building _____ for _____ so they can _____ faster / better / more clearly.

What a strong prototype looks like

REAL INPUT	AI PROCESS	CLEAR OUTPUT	HUMAN ACTION

Your prototype can be small. The judges should immediately understand what goes in, what AI does, what comes out, and what a person does next.

CHALLENGE 1 · SCREEN

Beyond the CV: AI-Assisted Candidate Screening

Why this problem exists

A company may receive dozens or hundreds of applications for one vacancy. CVs can arrive from JobStreet, LinkedIn, the company website, email or recruitment agencies. HR must read, organise and compare them before deciding who moves forward.

THE PROBLEM How can AI help HR review and screen many CVs from different recruitment channels faster, while still helping HR identify suitable candidates fairly?

Imagine this situation

A company receives 350 applications for one Software Developer vacancy. At only 3 minutes per CV, first-level screening already takes 17.5 hours. Important information is also written differently in every CV.

Your mission

Build a solution that helps HR collect, understand, compare and review many applications more efficiently.

What could you build?

- AI CV screening assistant
- Multi-platform candidate dashboard
- Job-criteria comparison tool
- Candidate summary generator

Step by step

1. Choose one job role.
2. Define the agreed job criteria.
3. Use fictional or anonymised CVs.
4. Let AI extract and compare important evidence.
5. Show HR a clear review dashboard.

Minimum output we want to see

JOB DESCRIPTION	MANY CVs	AI EXTRACTS + COMPARES	HR REVIEWS

IMPORTANT Do not let AI silently reject people. Show evidence, missing information and reasons for review.

SUCCESS QUESTION Can HR identify relevant candidates faster without manually reading every CV from beginning to end?

CHALLENGE 2 · MATCH

Better Talent Matching

Why this problem exists

After screening, HR may still struggle to decide which person fits which role best. Job titles are not enough. Skills, experience, interests, location, shifts and other practical needs can affect whether a match will work.

THE PROBLEM How can AI help HR match the right candidate to the right role using more than job titles and keywords?

Imagine this situation

HR has 60 people in its talent pool and three open positions. Some candidates applied for one role but may fit another role better. Manually comparing every person with every vacancy takes time and good candidates may be overlooked.

Your mission

Build a solution that compares candidate evidence with role requirements and explains strong, partial or alternative matches.

What could you build?

- Candidate-to-job matching dashboard
- Talent-pool search assistant
- Alternative-role recommender
- Skill-gap and fit explanation tool

Step by step

1. Choose two or three job roles.
2. Define the requirements for each role.
3. Create a small talent pool.
4. Use AI to structure skills and practical preferences.
5. Show HR reasons, gaps and questions to clarify.

Minimum output we want to see

TALENT POOL	ROLE REQUIREMENTS	AI MATCHES	HR CHOOSES NEXT STEP

IMPORTANT Avoid one unexplained match score. Show why the match exists and what still needs human confirmation.

SUCCESS QUESTION Can HR discover good or alternative matches that would be difficult to find by manually comparing job titles and CV keywords?

CHALLENGE 3 · HIRE

Fairer & Faster Hiring

Why this problem exists

After candidates are shortlisted, hiring can still become slow. Interview scheduling, manager approvals, repeated reviews, inconsistent interview questions and poor candidate updates create delays.

THE PROBLEM How can AI improve one step of the hiring process so HR and hiring managers move faster while using more consistent, job-relevant evaluation?

Imagine this situation

HR has shortlisted 20 candidates. Interviews require three managers. Different interviewers ask different questions, notes are kept in different places, and candidates wait days for updates.

Your mission

Choose one hiring-stage bottleneck and make that stage faster, clearer or more consistent.

What could you build?

- AI interview scheduling assistant
- Structured interview question generator
- Interview note summariser
- Candidate stage tracker and update assistant

Step by step

1. Map the hiring stages after shortlisting.
2. Choose one stage where work slows down.
3. Define what information users need.
4. Use AI to reduce repetitive work or organise information.
5. Show the next human action clearly.

Minimum output we want to see

SHORTLIST	HIRING STAGE	AI ASSISTS WORKFLOW	HUMAN DECISION

IMPORTANT AI can assist with scheduling, summaries and job-related evidence. Final hiring decisions remain accountable to people.

SUCCESS QUESTION Does your solution reduce waiting, repeated work or inconsistent evaluation in one real hiring stage?

CHALLENGE 4 · RETAIN

Early Employee Disengagement

Why this problem exists

Employees often show signs of difficulty before they resign: unclear expectations, weak onboarding, lack of support, workload issues or poor manager communication. HR may only discover the problem during an exit interview, when it is already too late.

THE PROBLEM How can AI help HR and managers understand employee difficulties earlier, so useful support can happen before disengagement becomes resignation?

Imagine this situation

Several new employees leave within six months. Exit interviews mention unclear priorities, weak onboarding and lack of feedback. HR wants to understand problems earlier instead of waiting until resignation.

Your mission

Build a solution that helps HR collect early feedback, identify recurring themes and trigger useful follow-up.

What could you build?

- New-employee check-in assistant
- Onboarding pulse survey analyser
- AI feedback-theme summariser
- Manager follow-up dashboard

Step by step

1. Choose one employee group, such as new hires.
2. Decide what voluntary feedback should be collected.
3. Use AI to summarise themes across responses.
4. Highlight issues that need follow-up.
5. Show and track a clear HR or manager action.

Minimum output we want to see

EMPLOYEE FEEDBACK	AI FINDS THEMES	HR / MANAGER REVIEWS	SUPPORT ACTION

IMPORTANT Do not secretly monitor employees or infer emotions from cameras or a single behaviour. Use transparent, voluntary information.

SUCCESS QUESTION Can HR understand emerging employee problems earlier and take a useful action before the issue becomes more serious?

CHALLENGE 5 · GROW

Purpose, Potential & Career Growth

Why this problem exists

HR may know an employee's current job title but still have limited visibility into strengths, transferable skills, career interests or development needs. This makes training generic and internal mobility difficult.

THE PROBLEM How can AI help HR and managers understand employee strengths and skill gaps, then recommend realistic development or internal career opportunities?

Imagine this situation

A company has 200 employees and several new roles opening next year. HR usually looks outside because it is difficult to see which existing employees already have related skills or could become ready with targeted development.

Your mission

Build a solution that helps the organisation develop and retain people by connecting current skills, career interests and future role requirements.

What could you build?

- Employee skills inventory
- Skill-gap analyser
- Internal career pathway recommender
- Personal development plan assistant

Step by step

1. Choose one employee group or future role.
2. Define the skills needed for that role.
3. Collect evidence of employee skills and interests.
4. Use AI to identify strengths and important gaps.
5. Recommend a realistic development pathway.

Minimum output we want to see

EMPLOYEE SKILLS	FUTURE ROLE	AI FINDS GAPS	DEVELOPMENT PATH

IMPORTANT Do not claim AI can predict a person's fixed potential or ideal career. Recommendations should remain explainable and discussable.

SUCCESS QUESTION Can the organisation identify realistic internal growth opportunities and give employees a clear next step for development?

What AIFM Expects From Your Final Project

Your prototype should solve a clear HR problem - not just demonstrate AI.

1. **THE HR PROBLEM** What is difficult, slow, unclear or inconsistent today?
2. **THE USER** Who uses your solution?
3. **CURRENT PROCESS** What happens today before your solution exists?
4. **YOUR SOLUTION** What exact function did you build?
5. **HOW AI IS USED** What information goes in, what does AI do, and what useful output comes out?
6. **HUMAN ACTION** What must a person still review, decide or do?
7. **TESTING** Did your prototype make the process faster, clearer, more consistent or more useful?

The five challenges as one HR journey

Challenge	HR Question	AI Helps With	Outcome
1. SCREEN	Review many applicants?	Read, extract, compare CVs	Faster first review
2. MATCH	Who fits which role?	Explain fit and alternatives	Better matching
3. HIRE	Where does hiring slow?	Assist workflow and evaluation	Faster hiring
4. RETAIN	What problems appear early?	Summarise feedback themes	Earlier support
5. GROW	How do we develop people?	Find strengths and gaps	Better growth

ONE RULE TO REMEMBER Start with a real HR problem. Use AI only where it creates measurable value. Keep important people decisions understandable and reviewable by humans.

Judging Criteria

Use this as a guide when deciding what to build, what to test, and what to show during your final pitch. Total: 100%.

15%	20%	20%	15%	10%	20%
PROBLEM	AI SOLUTION	INNOVATION	BUSINESS	ESG	PITCH

Weight	Criterion	What Judges Will Look For
15%	**Problem Identification & Understanding**	Clear, specific HR problem; who is affected; what happens today; why it matters; evidence or root cause behind the problem.
20%	**AI Solution & Functionality**	Working and useful solution; clear role for AI; meaningful improvement to the process; important decisions remain understandable and reviewable by people.
20%	**Innovation & Creativity**	Original or thoughtful idea; creative use of AI; a better approach than an obvious or purely manual solution; strong user experience.
15%	**Business & Economic Impact**	Potential to save time or cost, improve productivity, hiring quality, retention or decision-making; practical value, feasibility and scalability.
10%	**ESG Impact**	Responsible and sustainable impact such as fairness, privacy, inclusion, accessibility, employee wellbeing, governance or efficient use of resources. You do not need to cover every ESG area.
20%	**Pitch, Live Demo & Teamwork**	Clear story within the time limit; convincing live demo; strong Q&A; good teamwork; team members understand and can explain the project.

TIP FOR TEAMS

A strong project is not only about having a working app. Judges will look at the complete story: a real problem, a useful AI solution, originality, measurable impact, responsible thinking, and your ability to demonstrate it clearly as a team.

Final Pitch & Demo Requirements

Your final output is not only the prototype. Your team must explain the problem, present the solution, and demonstrate how it works.

PITCHING FORMAT

Each team must present its solution using presentation slides AND show a working demo or prototype.

TOTAL PITCHING TIME

8-10 minutes per team, INCLUDING judges' Q&A. Your team must manage the presentation, demo and Q&A within this total time.

SLIDE LIMIT

We recommend no more than 10 slides. Keep the presentation focused on the problem, solution, AI value and evidence that your idea works.

Recommended Time Planning

5-6 MIN PRESENTATION	1-2 MIN DEMO	1-2 MIN JUDGES Q&A

This is a suggested structure only. The important rule is that the complete session, including Q&A, must stay within 8-10 minutes.

Suggested Slide Structure - Maximum 10 Slides

1. Team & Challenge	Team name, selected challenge and one-sentence project idea.
2. The Real HR Problem	What happens today? Who experiences the problem? Why does it matter?
3. Evidence / Current Process	Show what you learned from users, research or the existing workflow.
4. Your Solution	Explain what you built and the user who will use it.
5. How It Works	Show the flow: input -> AI process -> output -> human action.
6. How AI Adds Value	Explain exactly what AI does and why it is better than a normal manual process.
7. Demo	Show the working prototype and one complete user journey.
8. Testing / Result	What did you test? What improved? What did users say?
9. Responsible AI	What must humans review? How do you reduce bias, errors, privacy or misuse risks?
10. Impact & Next Step	What value can this create for HR / the company, and what would you improve next?

FINAL REMINDER

Do not spend the whole pitch explaining features. Start with the HR problem, show how your solution solves it, demonstrate the product, and be ready to answer the judges' questions.

AI Tools You May Explore

You do not need to use all of these. Choose only the tools that help you understand the problem, build your solution, test it and present it clearly.

A SIMPLE RULE

You are NOT judged by how many AI tools you use. A strong project may use only one or two tools well. Judges should understand: Problem -> AI role -> Output -> Human action.

THINK & RESEARCH	**ChatGPT • Claude • Gemini • Perplexity**	Understand the challenge, generate interview questions, organise findings, compare ideas and research the market.
DESIGN	**Figma / Figma Make • Canva**	Create wireframes, user journeys, dashboards, app screens and presentation visuals.
BUILD	**Lovable • Bolt • Replit**	Quickly turn an idea into a working web prototype, especially for teams with limited coding experience.
CODE	**GitHub Copilot • Claude Code • ChatGPT**	Generate or explain code, debug problems, build APIs and improve a coded prototype.
DATA & BACKEND	**Supabase • Firebase**	Store sample candidate, job or employee data and support login, database and backend functions.
AUTOMATE	**n8n • Make • Zapier**	Connect forms, databases, email and AI into simple HR workflows and automations.

Suggested Starter Stacks

BEGINNER / LOW-CODE	ChatGPT or Gemini -> Figma/Canva -> Lovable/Bolt/Replit -> Supabase
CODING TEAM	Claude/ChatGPT -> Figma -> GitHub Copilot or Claude Code -> Supabase/Firebase
AUTOMATION PROJECT	ChatGPT/Claude -> n8n/Make/Zapier -> Google Sheets or Supabase -> Dashboard

IMPORTANT - USE SAFE SAMPLE DATA

Do not upload real confidential CVs, employee records or company personal data into public AI tools. For the competition, use fictional, anonymised or properly permitted sample data.